

Governor Chat

DAO ASSISTANT

I'll help you think through the Miss Tomato  partnership scenarios. Let me first check our context files for relevant partner and pricing strategies.

DAO ASSISTANT

Based on the context and your situation with Miss Tomato, here are the different scenarios I'd recommend considering for your visit:

Scenario Analysis for Miss Tomato Partnership

Scenario 1: Continue Current Arrangement (\$15 retail, \$11 cost)

Pros:

- Maintains existing relationship and shelf presence
- No disruption to current sales momentum (even if slow)
- Lower risk for both parties
- Keeps foot in the door for future product expansion

Cons:

- Below new standard pricing (\$25 retail)

- Squeezed margins (\$4 profit vs \$8 at new pricing)
- May devalue brand if other partners see the discrepancy
- Slow movement suggests this price point may not be optimal anyway

Scenario 2: Upgrade to New Pricing Tier (\$25 retail, \$17 wholesale)

Pros:

- Aligns with new brand positioning and pricing strategy
- Includes tree planting value proposition
- Better margins (\$8 profit vs \$4)
- Consistent across all partner locations

Cons:

- Risk of price resistance in non-apothecary setting
- May further slow already sluggish sales
- Could lose the partnership if they can't move product at this price

- Requires re-education of staff and customers

Scenario 3: Strategic Pause - Wait for Chocolate Bars (\$10/bar)

Pros:

- Addresses the "not really an apothecary" fit issue
- Lower price point (\$10 vs \$25) may move better in their space
- Chocolate bars have broader appeal than ceremonial cacao nibs
- Gives time to assess if cacao nibs are right for this location

Cons:

- Temporary gap in shelf presence
- Risk of losing the partnership momentum
- Need to develop and launch chocolate bars first
- Uncertain if chocolate bars will perform better

Scenario 4: Phase Out Cacao Nibs Gracefully

Pros:

- Clean exit from underperforming product/price mismatch
- Frees up inventory for better-performing locations
- Maintains relationship for future opportunities
- Aligns with "slowly getting out of cacao nibs space" observation

Cons:

...(truncated)

YOU

I don't think you're suitable for the hippie bike. They're more like a local mum and pop store. I don't think hippies go there and I don't think the health fitness fit actually goes there which we were trying to originally target with the Cacau nips

YOU

I don't think you're suitable for the hippie bike. They're more like a local mum and pop store. I don't think hippies go there and I don't think the health fitness fit actually goes there which we were trying to originally target with the Cacau nips

DAO ASSISTANT

You're absolutely right - that completely changes the analysis. If Miss Tomato is a local mum

and pop store rather than a health/fitness or hippie venue, then:

Revised Assessment

The core mismatch: Premium ceremonial cacao (\$25) is completely wrong for a neighborhood mum and pop store. These customers are looking for:

- Everyday, accessible products
- Familiar items they recognize
- Reasonable price points for regular purchases
- Not specialty wellness/ceremonial products

Your observation about cacao nibs moving slowly makes perfect sense now - you're trying to sell a premium wellness product to customers who just want their regular groceries.

Revised Recommendations

Best Option: Phase Out Cacao Nibs, Focus on Chocolate Bars

- **Why:** Chocolate bars at \$10 are much more suitable for a neighborhood store
- **Benefits:**
 - \$10 is an everyday price point, not a premium wellness price

- Chocolate is familiar and accessible to all customers
- Better product fit for the venue
- Maintains the relationship without forcing mismatched products

Alternative: Graceful Exit

- If chocolate bars aren't ready soon, it's better to politely phase out
- Explain: "We're shifting our product mix to better match neighborhood stores like yours"
- Leave door open for chocolate bars when available

What NOT to do:

- Don't push the \$25 ceremonial cacao - it's the wrong product for their customers
- Don't continue with slow-moving premium products that frustrate both parties

For Your Visit

Frame it as: "We've been looking at what works best for neighborhood stores like yours, and we're moving toward chocolate bars that we think will be a much better fit for your customers. Would you be interested in those when they're ready?"

This approach:

- Respects their actual customer base
- Doesn't force mismatched products
- Maintains the relationship
- Sets up future success with the right product

Does this revised approach feel more aligned with what you're seeing at Miss Tomato?

YOU

Actually, why even go there before we had the chocolate bars?

DAO ASSISTANT

You're absolutely right. That's a key insight - Miss Tomato sounds like a classic local mum and pop store, not the health/fitness/hippie demographic that would appreciate ceremonial cacao nibs at \$25.

Why this doesn't make sense right now:

1. **Product-venue mismatch** - Ceremonial cacao nibs are a niche, premium product for wellness-conscious consumers. A local mum and pop store typically serves everyday, practical needs.
2. **Wrong audience** - The "health fitness fit" you originally targeted isn't their customer base. You're trying to sell a specialty product to people who probably just want regular groceries.
3. **Pricing disconnect** - \$25 for ceremonial cacao is a stretch even in the right venues. In a general store, it's completely out of place.

Why visiting now is likely a waste of time:

- You already know the nibs are moving slowly there
- The venue doesn't attract your target customer
- The pricing strategy has evolved beyond what makes sense for this location
- You'd be trying to solve a problem that might not even be solvable with this product in this venue

Better approach:

1. **Hold off on the visit** until you have chocolate bars at \$10 - that's a much more natural fit for a local mum and pop store.
2. **Focus your energy** on venues that actually attract your target demographic - wellness shops, yoga studios, apothecaries, health food stores.
3. **Consider this a learning experience** - Not every venue is right for every product. Miss Tomato might be perfect for chocolate bars but terrible for ceremonial cacao nibs.

The question to ask yourself: If you had to choose between spending an hour visiting Miss Tomato to discuss slow-moving cacao nibs, or spending that hour finding 3 new wellness-focused venues that would be perfect for your \$25 ceremonial cacao - which would create more value?

Sometimes the best business decision is knowing when *not* to spend your time. Wait for the chocolate bars.

YOU

I'm thinking of paying Love of Ganesha a visit to check the sales of the bags of ceremonial Cacao over in her space has gone. She bought wholesale from us last night. There was before I left for winter from the San Francisco Bay area down to the desert so it's been a few months. Perhaps it's good to get some feedback from her if she's in the school and perhaps restock

DAO ASSISTANT

Great idea to check in with Love of Ganesha! Since she bought wholesale recently and

you've been away for a few months, this visit will give you valuable ground truth on how the ceremonial cacao is performing in her space.

What to Look For & Ask During Your Visit

Sales Performance Questions:

- "How have the ceremonial cacao bags been moving since you got them?"
- "Which sizes/varieties are selling best?"
- "What price point seems to work best for your customers?"
- "Are customers asking questions about the cacao? What are they curious about?"

Customer Feedback:

- "What kind of feedback have you heard from customers about the cacao?"
- "Who's buying it - regulars, new customers, specific types?"
- "Are there any common questions or concerns that come up?"

Display & Placement:

- "Where are you displaying the cacao in your space?"
- "Is it getting good visibility? Any suggestions for better placement?"
- "Do you have any signage or information about it?"

Restock Assessment:

- "What's your current inventory level?"
- "Would you like to restock now, or wait until you're lower?"
- "Any changes you'd like in the mix for the next order?"

Things to Observe:

- **Store vibe** - Does it feel like the right environment for ceremonial cacao?
- **Customer demographics** - Who's actually shopping there?
- **Product placement** - Is it prominently displayed or buried?
- **Staff knowledge** - Do they seem to understand the product?

Restock Decision Framework:

- **If selling well:** Restock and potentially expand the selection
- **If moving slowly:** Find out why - price point? Customer education? Wrong audience?
- **If wrong fit:** Consider whether to continue or phase out gracefully

This visit should give you much clearer data than just looking at sales numbers - you'll get the qualitative feedback that helps you understand the "why" behind the performance.

What's your sense of how Love of Ganesha's space compares to your target audience for ceremonial cacao?

YOU

It's right along haight street in SF. What do you think?

DAO ASSISTANT

Haight Street is actually PERFECT for ceremonial cacao! That's a completely different scenario from Miss Tomato.

Why Haight Street is Ideal:

Perfect Customer Demographics:

- **Hippie/bohemian heritage** - The birthplace of the 60s counter-culture movement

- **Wellness-conscious crowd** - People actively seeking spiritual and alternative health products
- **Higher disposable income** - Haight Street shoppers are generally more affluent
- **Culturally aware** - They understand ceremonial products and their significance
- **Willing to pay premium** - Used to specialty pricing for authentic, meaningful products

Right Environment:

- **Spiritual shops** - Haight Street has many metaphysical, yoga, and spiritual stores
- **Tourist destination** - Visitors looking for authentic SF experiences and products
- **Community vibe** - People who value community, ceremony, and connection

This Changes Everything:

Unlike Miss Tomato (mum and pop neighborhood store), Love of Ganesha on Haight Street is exactly where ceremonial cacao should thrive. The \$25 price point with tree planting is likely perfect for this audience.

What This Means for Your Visit:

1. **High expectations for sales** - This should be one of your better-performing locations

2. **Great feedback opportunity** - These customers will give you valuable insights about the product
3. **Potential for expansion** - If it's working well, you could potentially increase their inventory or add more varieties
4. **Case study potential** - Success here could be a model for other similar venues

Questions to Focus On:

- "How's the response been to the ceremonial aspect of the cacao?"
- "Are customers interested in the tree planting story?"
- "What price feedback are you getting?"
- "Would you like to carry more varieties or larger quantities?"

This visit could be really encouraging - Haight Street is exactly the kind of environment where ceremonial cacao should shine!

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